Kerstin Holzheu

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Research overview

www.kerstinholzheu.com

Assistant Professor, Sciences Po (2019–); PhD, Chicago (2018); IZA@LISER Research Fellow; CESifo Fellow.

Equilibrium labor-market models and linked employer–employee data to explain wage setting, worker mobility and firm productivity, and how skills, wealth and location shape workers' employment options.

2 published articles, 1 forthcoming | 3 R&Rs | 3 sole-PI grants

PUBLISHED AND FORTHCOMING

Journal of Labor Economics Published, 2023	**How Much Should We Trust Estimates of Firm Effects and Worker Sorting?** (S. Bonhomme, T. Lamadon, E. Manresa, M. Mogstad, B. Setzler) Documents limited-mobility bias and develops corrections; open-source `pytwoway` software.
Labour Economics Published, 2026	**The Two Faces of Worker Specialization** (Z. Bárány) Specialization raises re-employment wages but reduces job finding because suitable jobs are scarce.
International Economic Review Forthcoming	**Life-Cycle Wage Growth and Firm Productivity in Developed and Developing Economies** (J. Muñoz) Firm-productivity distributions explain most of life-cycle wage-growth gaps between Brazil & Colombia w/ US.

REVISE AND RESUBMIT

Review of Economic Studies	**Wage Bargaining and Wage Posting Firms** (J.-M. Robin) Recovers firms' contracting rules from wage and mobility histories in a job-ladder model.
Review of Economic Dynamics	**The Role of Workers in Knowledge Diffusion Across Firms** (A. Akerman) Estimates how worker mobility transmits knowledge and contributes to productivity growth.
Labour Economics	**Lost Knowledge and New Products: Event-Study Evidence from Worker Deaths** (A. Akerman) Identifies the contribution of workers' product-specific experience to firms' product entry.

OTHER MANUSCRIPTS AND ONGOING PROJECTS

Under review	**Separations on the Job Ladder** (L. Nolden). Wage changes and separations distinguish learning from wage renegotiation.
Working paper NBER SI, 2026	**Workplace Amenities and the Gender Pay Gap** (N. Datta Gupta, Y. Gallen, K. S. Hedeager). Administrative data and an incentivized amenities survey.
Working paper	**Worker Wealth and the Option of Self-Employment**. Equilibrium model of wages, startup capital and entry into self-employment.
Working paper	**Preserving Jobs, Freezing Dynamics? Employment Effects of Conditional Inheritance Tax Relief** (C. Bartels, T. Bührle, G. Locks, D. Roth). Inheritance-tax incentives and employment around family-firm transfers.
Ongoing	**The Option Value of Distance: Wages and Commuting in a Spatial Labor Market** (E. Mattana). Copenhagen bicycle-network expansions and job access.
Ongoing	**Acqui-Hires** (P. Corblet). M&A as complementary to hiring strategies, uses proprietary M&A valuation data merged to administrative firm data.
Ongoing	**Worker Specialization and the Aggregate Economy** (Sole Authored).

FUNDING AND ACADEMIC CONTRIBUTIONS

Funding. Three grants as sole PI: ANR JCJC FIRMSIZE (2024–27); Sciences Po SAB (2023–25 and 2027–28).

Recognition. Visiting Fellow/Professor, Yale/Cowles (2023–24); Visiting Position EIEF (3/2023); NBER SI 2026 Paper.

Research community. Lead organizer of SaM workshops in Aussois and at Sciences Po (2026); sole organizer, Young economist SaM workshop Andorra (2027). Co-organizer of the AI/labor conference with Georgetown Qatar and OECD (2027).

Teaching and doctoral supervision. *The Economy* and *Labor Economics and Policy*; co-supervision of 3 PhD students.

Refereeing. *American Economic Review*, *Journal of Political Economy*, *Review of Economic Studies*, *American Economic Review: Insights*, *Economic Journal*, *JPE Micro*, *Economic Policy*, *Journal of Urban Economics*, *Labour Economics*, *Econometrica*, *JRSS Series A*.